

Buried At Isle Wood

(Working Title)

Original Fiction Writing Sample

Genre:

Mystery / Thriller

Description: This is an original fiction project exploring mystery, character development, and narrative storytelling. This sample demonstrates my interest in storytelling and creating emotionally engaging experiences.

Skills Demonstrated:

- Storytelling
- Scene Building
- Narrative Structure
- Dialogue Writing
- Suspense & Atmosphere

Author:

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Chapter 1

“The famous boarding school The Isle Wood Academy, we all know of, has been doing tremendous amounts of charity for years, helping orphans get proper education. However, unfortunately, the diligent school has been marked by a serial killer—or could there be more?” She looked directly at the camera, her gaze refusing to drift away from it, her visage heavy as she continued, microphone clenched tightly in her hands. “No one knows yet.” Just when she said that, the wind passed by her in a swift gust, causing her dirty blonde hair to sway softly.

She let out a small breath she had been holding for a while before continuing. “Why are they only killing the teachers, one after another? The mystery remains unsolved, even though the best officers are on watch.” Before she could further report the news, the static noises coming out of the TV silenced her.

Soon, the TV was turned off, only reflecting the girl in front—carrying a hint of annoyance on her face, contrasting the beauty she possessed. Her thick, honey-toned hair was forcefully clipped back, waiting for an opportunity to slip out. Her upper eyelids hung heavy, like the earth bearing the weight of lives. Yet, her posture remained elegant, her back straight against the sofa.

She sighed, and her hands blindly started searching for her half-filled coffee mug, as her enchanting emerald eyes refused to dart away from the book in her hands. Her fingers aimlessly wandered—north and south—with no sense of direction. At last, her eyes relented to scan the room themselves. She then found it sitting on the other end of the table, at the edge, trying to survive like a lonely traveler.

She sipped her coffee, breaking the silence that had been haunting the room, and went back to her book, *The Investigator’s Little Black Book* by Robert Scott.

Just when she was so invested in the book, her phone started buzzing, demanding her attention. The book was abandoned on the table as she followed the buzzing sound. At last, she found the phone sitting on the sofa, hiding under the blanket. Before answering, she took a quick glance at the caller ID, which read “Dad” with some heart emojis following behind—and then the time, which was half past midnight.

“Hello? Dad?” she answered, concern lacing her voice, uncertain about the reason for his late-night call.

“Yes, hello?” He paused a little before continuing, “Jo.” His voice sounded hesitant, almost as if he was weighing his words before releasing them.

“Is everything okay? I mean... at work?” she inquired, full of worry, sensing the hesitation in his voice. However, her question was left unanswered. She waited. Ten seconds, twenty seconds, and still no answer. She moved her phone from her ear to her front to check if the call had been hung up by

mistake or something. Instead, the phone displayed one minute and forty-two seconds, then forty-three.

Concerned, she spoke to her phone again, “Hello? Dad? You still there?”

Finally, she heard a heavy sigh from the other end. Leaving her string of questions unanswered, the speaker continued, “Jo, I’m sorry. I really am.” The voice sounded weak and desperate in a way she had never heard before.

“Why are you apologizing?” Her voice was firm, demanding a reason behind his sudden apology as she attempted to hide her confusion. Before she could say anything more, her father cut her off.

“Let me speak, Jo.” He said it firmly, in an ordering tone—maybe to match hers. Then, he continued, “I—We need your help, Jo. But the thing is... it isn’t an easy task. It’s risky.” There was desperation hidden in his voice, even though he tried his best to decorate it with confidence.

She had never seen—or heard—him this desperate before in her whole 17 years of life. He had been her mother and father since her mom died giving birth to her at a very young age. He had never blamed her, not even once, even though she believed that if she had not been born, he could have been with the love of his life. Instead, he had treated her like a princess—his little Jo—and had done his best to fulfill her wishes all his life.

Once, when she wanted to be a detective like her father, he, together with his colleagues, planned a murder—a fake murder—and left out clues for her to find. For years, she thought she had actually solved that case until one of the colleagues-in-crime let the secret slip. After that, she cried for days before realizing what her father had done was out of love for her.

“Whatever it is, I am willing to do it,” she finally replied. This time, she was sure of herself. She was doing this not only for her kindest, sweetest, and most perfect dad—but for herself. This would make her the worthy daughter of her father. This was her chance.

He went quiet before questioning her impulsive decision, “Jo, you didn’t even ask me what type of favor I’m asking of you. How can you just say ‘yes’?” He was the one asking for a favor, yet instead of being happy, his fatherly instincts took over. He was her father after all. How could he not care?

She smiled before answering, “I love you, Dad. And of course, I trust you.”

He felt something inside him. Guilt. He couldn’t hold it in anymore. “Jo, the thing is... the government needs you, Judith Myers, to go undercover.” He paused, and just before she was about to say something, he further proclaimed, “I can’t explain anything more,” he said firmly, before mumbling, “The less you know, the safer you are.”

Hundreds—or even thousands—of thoughts whirled through her head. Why me? What case? What is Dad hiding? Why can’t he just tell me?